

Gifts to the worke. Nehemiah. The Law is read.

CHAP. VIII.

1 The religious maner of reading and hearing the Law. 9 They comfort the people. 13 The forwardnesse of them to heare and be instructed. 16 They keepe the feast of Tabernacles.

AND all the people gathered themselves together, as one man, into the street that was before the water gate,* and they spake vnto Ezra the scribe, to bring the booke of the Law of Moses, which the LORD had commanded to Israel.

* Ezra 3. 1. and 7. 6.

2 And Ezra the priest brought the Law before the Congregation, both of men and women, and all† that could heare with vnderstanding, vpon the first day of the seuenth moneth.

† Heb. that vnderstood in hearing.

3 And hee read therein before the street that was before the water gate,† from the morning vntill midday, before the men and the women, and those that could vnderstand: And the eares of all the people were attentue vnto the booke of the law.

† Heb. from the light.

4 And Ezra the scribe, stood vpon a pulpit of wood, which they had made for the purpose, and beside him stood Matithiah, and Shema, and Ananiah, and Uriah, and Hilkiah, and Maaseiah, on his right hand: and on his left hand, Gedaliah, and Shihai, and Bahchiah, and Hashum, and Hashbadana, Zechariah, and Meshullam.

† Heb. towre of wood.

5 And Ezra opened the booke in the† sight of all the people (for hee was aboue al the people) and when he opened it, all the people stood vp:

† Hebr. eyes.

6 And Ezra blessed the LORD the great God: and al the people answered, Amen, Amen, with lifting vp their hands: and they bowed their heads, and worshipped the LORD, with their faces to the ground.

7 Also Ieshua and Bani, and Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodajah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, Delaiah, and the Leuites, caused the people to vnderstand the law: and the people stood in their place.

8 So they read in the booke, in the Law of God distinctly, and gaue the sense, and caused them to vnderstand the reading.

9 And Nehemiah, which is the Tirshatha, and Ezra the Priest the Scribe, and the Leuites that taught the

|| Or, the governor.

by also from Tel-Melah, Tel-Haresa, Cherub, Addon, and Immer: but they could not shewe their fathers house, nor their seede, whether they were of Israel.

|| Or, pedegres

62 The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, sixe hundred fourtie and two.

63 And of the priests: the children of Ihabaiah, the children of Buz, the children of Barzillai, which tooke one of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite to wife, and was called after their name.

64 These sought their register, among those that were reckoned by genealogie, but it was not found: therefore were they, as polluted, put from the priesthood.

|| Or, the governor.

65 And the Tirshatha said vnto them, that they should not eate of the most holy things, till there stood vp a priest with Urin and Thummim.

66 The whole congregation together, was fourtie and two thousand, three hundred and threescore:

67 Beside their man seruants, and their maid seruants, of whome there were seuen thousand, three hundred, thirtie and seuen: and they had two hundred fourtie and fve singing men and singing women.

68 Their horses, seuen hundred, thirtie and sixe: their mules, two hundred fourtie and fve:

69 Their camels, foure hundred thirtie and fve: sixe thousand, seuen hundred and twentie asses.

† Hebr. part.

70 And some of the chiefe of the fathers, gaue vnto the worke: The Tirshatha gaue to the treasure, a thousand drammes of gold, fiftie balons, fve hundred and thirtie priests garments.

71 And some of the chiefe of the fathers gaue to the treasure of the worke twentie thousand drammes of golde, and two thousand and two hundred pound of siluer.

72 And that which the rest of the people gaue, was twentie thousand drammes of gold, and two thousand pound of siluer, and threescore and seuen priests garments.

73 So the priests, and the Leuites, and the porters, and the singers, and some of the people, and the Bethunims, and all Israel, dwelt in their cities: And when the seuenth moneth came, the children of Israel were in their cities.